

MIGRAFILE

U.S. NONIMMIGRANT VISAS

Client Questionnaire, Document Requirements & Forms Inventory

Complete reference organized from the preceding conversation. English-language content retained for client intake and application preparation.

How to use this guide

Use a separate questionnaire for each applicant, including children. Start with the universal intake and add only the questions and documents relevant to the selected category. This intake is not a replacement for an official government application.

Where applications go

Most visa applications are submitted to the U.S. Department of State through a U.S. embassy or consulate, using DS-160. Certain categories first require a USCIS petition. Documents uploaded to your service's client portal are separate from documents submitted to the government; DS-160 generally does not accept a complete supporting-document package. Follow the selected embassy's submission instructions. [1, 4]

Contents

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Scope: A category and procedure inventory, not a package every applicant files. Current official instructions and the selected embassy's requirements control.

1. Nonimmigrant visa categories

Category	Main purpose	Family/dependent category
B-1	Temporary business activities	Family applies separately for an appropriate visa
B-2	Tourism, family visits, medical treatment	Separate applications
B-1/B-2	Combined business and visitor visa	Separate applications
F-1	Academic or language study	F-2
M-1	Vocational or nonacademic study	M-2
J-1	Approved exchange visitor program	J-2
H-1B	Specialty occupation employment	H-4
H-1B1	Specialty occupation professionals from Chile or Singapore	H-4
H-2A	Temporary agricultural employment	H-4
H-2B	Temporary nonagricultural employment	H-4
H-3	Certain training or special education exchange programs	H-4
L-1A / L-1B	Intracompany managers/executives or specialized knowledge employees	L-2
O-1	Extraordinary ability or achievement	O-3
O-2	Qualifying support personnel for O-1 activities	O-3
P-1	Certain athletes, teams or entertainment groups	P-4
P-2	Reciprocal exchange artists or entertainers	P-4
P-3	Culturally unique artists or entertainers	P-4
E-1	Treaty traders and qualifying employees	E dependent classification
E-2	Treaty investors and qualifying employees	E dependent classification
E-3	Australian specialty occupation professionals	E-3 dependent classification
TN	Qualifying Canadian or Mexican professionals	TD
I	Representatives of foreign information media	I for qualifying dependents
R-1	Temporary religious workers	R-2
Q-1	International cultural exchange	No dedicated Q dependent category
Category	Main purpose	Family/dependent category
C-1	Transit through the United States	Separate appropriate applications
C-2 / C-3	Certain UN or official-government transit	Depends on circumstances
D	Ship or aircraft crewmembers	Separate appropriate applications
C-1/D	Transit combined with crewmember travel	Separate appropriate applications

Category	Main purpose	Family/dependent category
A-1 / A-2	Diplomats and other foreign government officials	Qualifying immediate family under A
A-3	Attendants, servants or personal employees of A visa holders	Special rules
G-1-G-4	International organization representatives and employees	Qualifying immediate family under G
G-5	Attendants, servants or personal employees of G visa holders	Special rules
NATO-1-NATO-6	Qualifying NATO personnel and family	Depends on principal classification
NATO-7	Qualifying attendants or personal employees	Special rules
K-1	Fiance(e) of a U.S. citizen	K-2 children
K-3	Certain spouses of U.S. citizens	K-4 children
T	Certain victims of human trafficking	Qualifying derivative T classifications
U	Certain victims of qualifying criminal activity	Qualifying derivative U classifications
S	Certain witnesses or informants	S-7 qualifying family
V	Limited legacy category for certain LPR spouses and children	V-1 / V-2 / V-3
N-8 / N-9	Certain relatives of special immigrants	Specialized eligibility
CW-1	CNMI-only transitional workers	CW-2
E-2C	CNMI-only legacy investor classification	Specialized dependent rules

This inventory includes common and specialized classifications; eligibility, nationality restrictions and dependent rules differ. K visas are legally nonimmigrant visas but serve immigration-related purposes. ESTA/Visa Waiver Program travel is not a visa category. [2, 10]

2. General client questionnaire

Complete separately for every applicant, including children. This is an intake questionnaire, not a replacement for the official DS-160.

Question	Information to collect
What is your full legal name?	Surname and given names exactly as shown in the passport
What is your name in your native alphabet?	Native-language spelling, where applicable
Have you used any other names?	Previous names, aliases, maiden names
What is your date and place of birth?	Date, city, state/province, country
What is your sex and marital status?	Current information
What citizenships do you hold or have you held?	All current and previous nationalities
Are you a permanent resident of another country?	Country and supporting status document
Do you have a national identification number?	Number, if applicable
Have you been issued a U.S. SSN or taxpayer identification number?	Number, if applicable
Where do you currently live?	Complete physical address
Is your mailing address different?	Complete mailing address
What are your contact details?	Current telephone numbers and email
What previous telephone numbers and email addresses have you used?	History for the period requested by DS-160
Which social media platforms and identifiers have you used?	Identifiers for the requested period; never collect passwords
What passport will you use?	Type, number, issuing authority/country, issue and expiration dates
Have any passports been lost or stolen?	Passport details and explanation
Why are you traveling to the United States?	Applicant's stated purpose and intended activities
Which visa category are you applying for?	Applicant-selected category or category in sponsor/petition documents
Where will you apply?	Embassy/consulate and country of nationality or residence
When do you intend to travel?	Proposed arrival and duration
Where will you stay?	U.S. address or proposed accommodation
Who is paying for the trip?	Applicant, employer, sponsor or another person
Are you traveling with anyone?	Names, relationships and group details
Who is your U.S. contact?	Person/organization, address, telephone, relationship
Have you previously visited the United States?	Dates, duration, status; collect more history if needed
Have you previously received a U.S. visa?	Visa category, issuance details, copy
Has a U.S. visa been lost, stolen, canceled or revoked?	Dates and explanation

Question	Information to collect
Have you ever been refused a U.S. visa or admission?	Date, post/port, refusal notice and explanation
Has anyone filed an immigrant petition for you?	Petitioner, form, date, receipt number, outcome
What are your parents' details?	Names, birth dates if known, U.S. presence/status
Do you have relatives in the United States?	Names, relationships, status
What are your spouse's details?	Name, birth details, nationality, address
Have you been previously married?	Prior spouses, marriage and termination details
What is your current occupation?	Employer/school, address, duties, start date, income
What previous employment have you had?	Employers, dates, duties, contact information
What education have you completed?	Institutions, courses, attendance dates
What languages do you speak?	List
Which countries have you visited?	History for the period requested
Have you belonged to professional, social or charitable organizations?	Names and relevant details
Have you served in the military?	Country, branch, rank, specialty, service dates
Do you have specialized weapons, explosives, nuclear, biological or chemical training?	Details, if applicable
Has anyone helped prepare your application?	Preparer identity and assistance provided
Have you reviewed and confirmed every answer?	Applicant acknowledgment before submission

DS-160 questions vary according to the applicant and travel purpose. Collect the exact history periods requested by the live application. The applicant ordinarily electronically signs the application; special procedures apply to children and applicants unable to complete it themselves. [1]

Security and immigration history questions

Collect separate Yes/No answers and explanations for the official questions concerning:

- Relevant communicable diseases, physical or mental conditions, and drug abuse/addiction.
- Arrests, convictions, controlled-substance violations, prostitution, money laundering and trafficking.
- Security-related activities, terrorism, espionage, violence and human-rights violations.
- Immigration fraud or misrepresentation.
- Overstays, unauthorized employment, removal/deportation and other immigration violations.
- Unlawful voting, certain citizenship-related conduct and international child-custody issues.

Use the exact wording of the live DS-160 when preparing the application; these summaries should not replace its individual questions. [1]

3. General document checklist

A. Core application documents

Document	When to collect
Current passport biographical page	All applicants
Relevant previous passport and U.S. visa pages	If applicable
Visa photograph	Per current Department of State specifications
DS-160 confirmation page	After submission
Appointment confirmation	After booking, where applicable
Visa application fee receipt	If payment/receipt is required
Residence permit or other proof of lawful residence	If applying based on residence in another country
Previous refusal or 221(g) notices	If applicable
USCIS petition approval or receipt details	Petition-based categories
Embassy-specific checklist	For the selected post and category

For many visas, the passport must be valid for at least six months beyond the intended stay, subject to country-specific exemptions. If digital photo upload fails, follow the instructions for bringing a printed photo. [3, 4]

B. Conditional supporting documents

Document	Purpose
Employment letter, leave approval, payslips	Employment and planned absence
Business registration and business records	Self-employment/business activities
Bank statements or funding evidence	Ability to pay relevant expenses
Sponsor letter and sponsor funding records	Third-party financial support
Proposed itinerary	Purpose and duration of travel
Invitation, conference registration or business correspondence	Relevant business or visit purpose
Enrollment letter or academic records	Current study or educational history
Marriage/birth certificates	Relationship or dependent applications
Property, lease, family or other relevant records	Relevant home-country circumstances
Court records and immigration decisions	If disclosed history requires them
Translations	As required by the receiving agency or embassy

These are conditional evidence, not a universal mandatory package. There is no universal rule requiring a particular bank balance or six months of statements. For visitor visas, invitation letters and an Affidavit of Support are not required. Do not purchase final tickets before a visa is issued. [3]

4. Category-specific intake

Add the relevant questions and documents to the general intake. Requirements are conditional on the classification, facts and consular instructions.

Visa/service	Additional client questions	Additional documents
B-2 tourism / family visit	Why this trip? Who will you visit? How long? Who pays? What obligations require your return?	Proposed itinerary, relevant visit information, funding evidence, employment/other relevant home ties
B-1 business	Which meetings, conference, negotiations or business activities? Who employs you? Will you perform work or receive U.S. payment?	Business invitation/correspondence, conference registration, employer letter, funding records
B-2 medical treatment	Diagnosis? Why U.S. treatment? Provider? Estimated duration/cost? Who pays?	Local physician's diagnosis, U.S. provider's acceptance and treatment/cost estimate, proof of funds
F-1 / M-1	School/program? SEVIS ID? Start date? Academic background? Who funds tuition and living costs?	Signed I-20, I-901 payment evidence where required, academic records, funding evidence
F-2 / M-2	Relationship to student? Principal's SEVIS/status details?	Each dependent's I-20, marriage/birth certificate, principal's relevant visa/status documents
J-1	Sponsor/program? SEVIS ID? Placement? Funding? Previous J participation?	DS-2019, I-901 payment evidence where required, sponsor/funding records; DS-7002 for applicable intern/trainee programs
J-2	Relationship to principal? Principal's program/status?	Each dependent's DS-2019, relationship documents, principal's relevant documents
H categories	Employer? Position/duties? Qualifications? Petition number? Worksite?	Petition/approval details, employer letter, relevant qualifications; category-specific labor/training records
L-1	Foreign and U.S. companies? Qualifying relationship? Employment abroad? Role? Blanket petition?	Petition/approval details, employment evidence, corporate relationship records; I-129S for blanket L cases
O / P	Field, achievements, events, itinerary, agent/employer, supporting role?	Petition/approval details, contracts, itinerary, qualifications/achievement evidence as relevant
E-1	Treaty nationality? Ownership? Nature and volume of treaty trade? Employee role?	Nationality/ownership records, trade records, business records, DS-156E where required
E-2	Treaty nationality? Source and amount of funds? Investment committed? Operating business? Ownership/control?	Lawful source/path of funds, investment transactions, ownership and operating records, business plan; DS-156E for applicable employees
E-3	Australian nationality? Specialty occupation? Degree? Employer? Licensing?	Certified Labor Condition Application, job offer, degree/qualification and licensing evidence
TN / TD	Canadian/Mexican nationality? Listed profession? Job duties? Qualifications?	Employer letter, credentials/license, nationality evidence; relationship documents for TD
I media	Media employer? Assignment? Journalism activities? Duration?	Employer/assignment letter, press credentials and relevant contracts
R-1 / R-2	Religious organization? Membership history? Role? Petition? Relationship?	Petition/approval details, organization and employment evidence; relationship records
Q-1	Approved cultural exchange employer/program? Duties? Petition?	Petition/approval details, program and employment documents

Visa/service	Additional client questions	Additional documents
C / D / C-1/D	Destination? Transit route? Ship/aircraft? Crew role? Joining date?	Onward itinerary/entry permission where relevant, crew contract or employer letter
A / G / NATO	Official position? Sending government/organization? Assignment? Family or employee relationship?	Diplomatic note or official request, assignment/orders, relationship records; employee contract where applicable
K-1 / K-2	Petitioner? Relationship history? Prior marriages? Meeting history? Marriage plans? Children?	Approved petition, civil and relationship records, police certificates, medical examination, financial evidence per instructions
K-3 / K-4	Marriage? I-130/I-129F history? Children?	Petition records, civil/relationship documents, medical and police records per consular instructions
T / U	USCIS case and approval? Derivative relationship? Location? Requested consular action?	USCIS case/approval documents and category-specific evidence; specialist handling
S / V / N / CW / E-2C	Sponsoring authority, legacy eligibility, territorial eligibility, principal/dependent details?	Dedicated category-specific checklist rather than a general visitor checklist

Student and exchange documentation is issued by the school or designated sponsor; these are not forms that a document-preparation service independently issues. [5, 6, 7]

Employment categories have different petition prerequisites. E applications require enterprise and nationality evidence, and the DS-156E requirement differs between principal investors and employees. [4, 8]

K applications require a separate checklist because their medical, police, civil and financial requirements differ substantially from ordinary visitor applications. [9]

5. Government forms inventory

Department of State, student and exchange forms

Form	Name/purpose	When applicable
DS-160	Online Nonimmigrant Visa Application	Main consular application for most NIV categories, including K
DS-156E	Nonimmigrant Treaty Trader/Investor Application	E-1 applicants and applicable E-1/E-2 executives, managers or essential employees
DS-1648	Online Application for A, G or NATO Visa	Applicable applications made within the United States
DS-2019	Certificate of Eligibility for Exchange Visitor Status	J applicants; issued by designated sponsor
DS-7002	Training/Internship Placement Plan	Applicable J intern/trainee programs
DS-5535	Supplemental Questions for Visa Applicants	Only when requested
DS-3035	J-1 Visa Waiver Recommendation Application	Separate J waiver procedure
I-20	Certificate of Eligibility for Nonimmigrant Student Status	F/M applicants; issued by school
I-901	SEVIS fee payment	Applicable F/M/J applicants

Older forms: DS-156, the former NIV use of DS-157 and DS-158 are not routine additional forms for standard DS-160 applications. DS-158 still appears on the State Department forms directory, but its DS-160 FAQ explains that DS-160 replaced these older routine applications. [1, 11]

USCIS and related forms - relevant procedure only

Form	Purpose
I-129 and applicable classification supplements	Employer/petitioner request for nonimmigrant worker classification
I-129S	Nonimmigrant petition based on a blanket L petition
I-129CW	CNMI-only nonimmigrant transitional worker petition
I-129F	Petition for Alien Fiance(e), including applicable K-3 use
I-130	Underlying spouse immigrant petition relevant to K-3 processing
I-539	Extend/change eligible nonimmigrant status inside the United States
I-539A	Supplemental information for qualifying I-539 co-applicants
I-765	Employment authorization, where classification permits an application
I-907	Premium processing for eligible requests
I-102	Replacement/initial nonimmigrant arrival-departure document in applicable cases
I-94	Arrival/Departure Record; generally a record, not the visa application
I-134	Declaration of Financial Support, where applicable or requested
I-612	Certain J exchange visitor two-year residence requirement waiver applications

Form	Purpose
I-192	Advance permission to enter as a nonimmigrant in qualifying cases
I-212	Permission to reapply for admission after deportation/removal, where applicable
I-914, Supplements A/B	T status application, qualifying family request, law enforcement declaration
I-918, Supplements A/B	U status petition, qualifying family request, law enforcement certification
I-929	Qualifying family petition associated with a U-1 principal's adjustment process
I-854 / I-854A / I-854B	Specialized S classification/interagency procedures
I-566	Interagency record for applicable A/G/NATO-related requests
G-28	Appearance by an eligible attorney or accredited representative
G-1145	E-notification for qualifying lockbox filings

These are a procedure-based inventory, not a package every visa applicant files. Use the current official instructions for the selected form, supplements, fees, signatures and filing method. [12]

6. Upload and submission handling

Item	Client portal	Government handling
Questionnaire and supporting scans	Upload for preparation/review	Not automatically submitted to the government
DS-160	Keep draft/review record and confirmation	Submit electronically through CEAC
Digital visa photo	Upload	Upload to DS-160 where required
Passport	Upload scan	Present/send original only under embassy instructions
Supporting evidence	Upload relevant documents	Bring or submit as directed by the embassy
Employer petition	Keep relevant records	Petitioner files with USCIS where required
I-20 / DS-2019	Upload copy	Present required signed document under consular instructions
Extra documents requested under 221(g)	Upload for tracking	Submit using the method on the embassy's notice
Medical examination	Track completion for applicable categories	Follow panel physician/embassy instructions

MigraFile workflow

Make the core intake universal, then show category-specific questions and documents. Mark every document **Required / Conditional / Optional**, and track **Missing / Uploaded / Reviewed / Submitted** separately. An uploaded document should only become "Submitted" after the actual government submission is recorded.

Official starting links

[DS-160 application](#)

[Visa categories](#)

[State Department forms](#)

[Embassies and consulates](#)

[USCIS forms](#)

7. Official reference links

Numbered references replace the citation widgets from the conversation. Click a title to open its official source. This PDF preserves the preceding guide; it is not a new verification of changing policies.

- [1] [DS-160: Frequently Asked Questions](#)
- [2] [Directory of Visa Categories](#)
- [3] [Visitor Visa](#)
- [4] [Temporary Worker Visas](#)
- [5] [Student Visa](#)
- [6] [Exchange Visitor Visa](#)
- [7] [BridgeUSA: How to Apply](#)
- [8] [Treaty Trader / Investor and E-3 Visas](#)
- [9] [Nonimmigrant Visa for a Fiance\(e\) \(K-1\)](#)
- [10] [Other Visa Categories](#)
- [11] [Department of State: Forms](#)
- [12] [USCIS: Forms](#)

Additional official reference

[DS-156E official form and evidence examples](#)